

The Combine

Enigma Factsheet · Combine

The Combine, or 'Davison chart', was introduced independently by two astrologers. First by Heinrich Schiffmann and shortly afterwards by Ronald Davison. The Combine is the horoscope for the midpoint in time and place of two, or more, partners.

Basic idea

For a Combine you calculate two average values: in time and in place. The value for time is unambiguous: you take the moment that, in days, hours, minutes and seconds, falls exactly between the birth times of the partners.

For an average place this is more difficult. Almost invariably you find that authors take the average between the two longitudes and between the two latitudes, and geographically speaking that yields incorrect results. The earth is spherical, and you have to take that into account in the calculation.

If people were born not too far from each other, or at a comparable latitude, the difference will not be large. When it concerns places that lie far apart, the difference for the cusps can indeed rise substantially

Variants

There are several variants of the Combine. Enigma supports:

- Simplified. This method ignores the spherical shape of the earth and calculates the average time and the average coordinates. This method was used by Heinrich Schiffmann.
- Original. Like the simplified method, but now you calculate the midpoint of the MC and the corresponding cusps for the location found. This method was proposed by Ronald Davison.
- Reference location. You calculate the average time but not the average location. Instead, you use the place of residence of both partners. That is of course only possible if the partners live together or live close to each other.
- Spherical midpoint. This method calculates the geographically correct midpoint for the location, taking into account the spherical shape of the earth. This can produce large differences from the other methods. It is thus conceivable that the arc with the shortest distance runs via the polar region and the location for this Combine falls in the polar region.

Which to choose?

If you take the view that it is about the true midpoint, only the 'Spherical midpoint' method remains. If you consider it important to align with what is customary, you can choose one of the other variants. The reference location solves many practical problems, but it is not always the case that partners live in the same place. And that location can change over the course of a relationship.

In many cases partners will have been born in locations that are not too far apart, in which case the differences between the four methods are less pronounced.

Progressions

Because a Combine is a real horoscope, you can calculate transits and various directions and progressions. Enigma does not yet offer this possibility.



1. Davison, Ronald. *Synastry: Understanding Human Relations Through Astrology*. New York, ASI Publishers, 1977.
2. Rieger, Mona. *Handbuch der Combin- und Composit-Deutung: Seelische Partnerverbindungen im Horoscop*. Freiburg im Breisgau, Ebertin, 1998.
3. Schiffmann, Heinrich. *Das Combin, Beispiele der Anwendbarkeit*. Sonderheft Qualität der Zeit, Heft II, März 1979, p. 25-29.